SCO remain useful talk shops with their own constraints while AIIB's lending has been limited. Despite its rapid expansion to include countries such as Egypt, Iran, Ethiopia, and the United Arab Emirates, BRICS has focused on safeguarding its members' sovereignty. In recent years, the agenda has focused on finding alternative mechanisms to the US dollar for trading. The SCO, meanwhile, remains a useful vehicle for India to engage the Central Asian Republics.

Despite the sharp and systemic differences, India can continue to work with Beijing when possibilities present themselves. One relatively recent example involved the Financial Action Task Force, where in 2018 China dropped its resistance to including Pakistan on a terrorism 'grey list' in exchange for Indian support for a leadership position for China in that international organization. [45] At other points, there may even be convergence on international issues. Engagement between the leaderships and business communities of the two largest countries in the world may still be both useful and necessary. But any such dialogue, especially if not conducted in the spirit of open-mindedness and mutual respect, is of limited value.

India cannot afford to delude itself into believing that the direct and indirect challenges associated with China's rise will disappear on their own. The consequences for India's security and territoriality, its economic well-being, and its overall rise in the international system would be far too great. Working towards a healthy bilateral relationship with Beijing is necessary, but the odds of that will be greater only if India can increase its economic and military power, preserve a regional leadership role, and actively shape the balance of power in the Indo–Pacific.